

Mission

Jaldhaara Foundation aims to develop and implement sustainable Water Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH) solutions over two thousand communities by 2024

Context

Jaldhaara is a not for profit organization that works with the vision to build solutions to provide safe water, sanitation and hygienic practices in unaddressed, isolated and marginalized communities in India.

About 78 million people do not have access to clean drinking water across the globe. Jaldhaara hopes to make a difference here by providing access to clean drinking water by purifying any water source to the World Health Organization's standards and to do it at affordable prices because they strongly believe that all communities deserve access to the same or comparable quality of drinking water. Where the standard price of a 20lt bottle of water is 20Rs, Jaldhaara sells their water at a fraction of the price that is 8-10 Rs for 20lts by partnering with other organizations to bring clean drinking water to Indian communities.

They partner with WaterHealth that has over 450 active decentralized water purification units WaterHealth Centers (WHCs) across several states, catering to over seven million underserved community members. WaterHealth also has an extensive mechanism of DSPs (Delivery Service Providers) who are young entrepreneurs from the community facilitating transportation of water from the WHC to nearby locations (schools and residences).

WaterHealth Centers can typically serve a community of population ranging from 5,000 to 20,000 through the installation of DCWS (decentralized community water systems known as Waterhealth Centers. Jaldhaara raises the funds to procure and install the water purification plant based on a Build Operate Transfer (BOT) agreement signed with the Local Government Agency, i.e. Panchayat or Municipality, with a concession term spanning 20-25 years.

They run the 'Water for Schools' program that attempts to reach out to government schools in the vicinity of the water purification units through their existing network of DSPs which results in students getting safe and affordable drinking water for the entire year or as per the term stipulated

by the funding partner. Through this effort, Jaldhaara lowered absenteeism by 49% in these schools.

Jaldhaara also works with Maithri Aquatech, their international innovative partner and a pioneer in the of AWG technology (Atmospheric Water Generators). Their state-of -the-art 'MEGHDOOT' solution is a nature-based renewable water technology that is sustainable and scalable to meet all demands for, of and by water.

Additionally, Jaldhaara Foundation implements Community Awareness Programs, which generate awareness among the communities at large on various social issues and concerns. They spend time interacting with villagers, seeing first-hand the daily challenges they face, the potential that exists for change and the impact that they can make to improve the health of the community. Their key focus is to create awareness on Water, Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH) within the communities and schools.

On various days like World Water Day, World Toilet Day, Global Handwashing day, and World Environment Day, Jaldhaara Foundation conducts special WASH awareness sessions for schools where children participate to spread the importance of Water and Sanitation. They invite corporates to contribute, participate in these activities and engage with the students and communities. This incentivizes more corporate donations which are imperative to further the cause of the organization.

Challenge

The biggest challenge facing the NGO currently is a lack of funds to expand and scale their projects.

The organization has a network of donors that they regularly work with to fund their projects. These donors mostly comprise of corporates that are interested in the cause of clean water and sanitation.

According to the Companies Act 2013, certain classes of profitable organizations have to shell out at least 2 percent of the three-year annual net profit towards Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) activities in a particular financial year.

To comply with this act, companies have a publicly available CSR policy that details the project areas they are interested in contributing towards, the scope, strategy, approach and action plan through which one can identify the companies that have 'drinking water' as one of their focus areas.

Over the past few years, donations have been dwindling due to a divergence in priorities of the donors from the cause of drinking water. Majority of funds come from existing donor companies. The individual contributions that come in through their website have been observed to be sporadic and generally small.

The NGO is looking for a solution that will help them find new donors, preferably corporate companies, and enable them to further their cause. The solution should target companies that have 'drinking water' or 'hygiene and sanitation' as their focuses so that the organization can approach them for donations. They also want the solution to present the data obtained in an easily usable way and provide leads to obtain more donations.

Additional Considerations

The solution should provide clear data on which organizations are likely to donate and manage expectations. The solution could also be able to use these leads to provide actionable insights into the best suggestive course of action to obtain donations.

Technology Baseline

Currently, the NGO works mostly with their list of existing donors with whom they have had a relationship for a very long time and there isn't a specific technology based system in place to find new donors. They go through the list of companies in National Stock Exchange and Bombay Stock Exchange and identify those that fall like the bracket that need to comply with the Companies Act 2013. They then read the CSR policies of these companies and identify those that have drinking water or sanitation and hygiene in their focus areas.